Voice Input Research Kit — Job Seekers (Milestone 2)

Nov 11, 2026 · @Chirag P C

Segments

The focus segment is **job seekers and early-career professionals (21–30)**: they use ChatGPT heavily, prepare for interviews that are spoken, yet still type everything.

Segment	Who	Main ChatGPT jobs	Voice fit	Reachable for research
Students (18–24)	College students, exam aspirants	Homework, concepts, coding	Medium: often in hostels, classrooms	High
Job seekers & young professionals (21–30)	Final-years, freshers, people switching jobs	Résumés, cover letters, mock interviews, emails	**High: interviews are spoken; practising out loud is the actual job**	**High (your network, LinkedIn, Nextleap cohort)**
Content creators	Reels/YouTube creators, freelancers	Scripts, captions, ideas	High for brainstorming	Medium
Regional-language users	Tier 2/3, Hindi or regional-first users	Everyday questions, translation	Very high, but needs Indic accuracy first	Low for a 2-week sprint
Working professionals (30+)	Managers, small business owners	Emails, summaries, planning	Medium: commute, hands-busy moments	Medium

Why job seekers:

- **Size and pain:** about 11 million graduates aged 20–29 were unemployed in 2023 (State of Working India 2026). Only 32% of job seekers feel interview-ready, 26% in Tier 3 towns (Apna Interview Readiness Index 2025).
- **Already AI users:** 94% of Indian job seekers plan to use AI in their search, and 66% say it boosts interview confidence (LinkedIn, Jan 2026).
- **Natural voice use case:** a mock interview is spoken by nature, so if voice can't win here, it won't win anywhere.

- **Feasible:** you can recruit 30+ respondents and 6 interviewees from your own network inside two weeks.

Hypotheses

Each hypothesis maps to survey questions (Q#) and interview probes, so the results confirm or kill it.

#	Hypothesis	Why it might be true	Tested by	Kill condition
H1	**Social awkwardness:** they're rarely alone (PGs, shared rooms, offices, metro), so speaking to an AI feels embarrassing	Most young job seekers in India live in shared spaces	Q6, Q7, interview	Under 30% name "people around me" as a reason
H2	**Accent and Hinglish distrust:** they expect voice to mishear Indian English or code-mixing, so typing feels safer	Hindi-English tuning only reached ChatGPT in Oct 2026	Q8, Q10, interview	Under 25% report an accuracy worry
H3	**Loss of control:** job-search prompts are precise (résumé lines, JD details), and they want to see and edit text before sending	Users have complained that dictation lost review-before-send	Q8, Q9, interview	Most say they don't edit typed prompts
H4	**Low awareness of value:** they know the mic exists but don't see when voice beats typing, e.g. for spoken mock-interview practice	No onboarding or nudge in the app	Q4, Q5, Q11	Over 50% have already tried voice for mock interviews
H5	**Habit and speed perception:** typing on a phone is already fast for them, so voice offers no visible gain	Gen Z types fluently; English-medium users	Q3, Q8	Most rate voice as faster than typing yet still don't use it (then H1–H3 dominate)

#	Hypothesis	Why it might be true	Tested by	Kill condition
H6	**Privacy:** they don't want career details (salary, current employer) recorded as audio	Audio feels more permanent than text	Q8, interview	Under 15% mention privacy

Your primary bet going in is **H1 + H3**: voice fails job seekers in *where* they are and *how precise* their prompts must be. H2 is the likely amplifier.

Survey

Twelve questions, about 3 minutes, for a Google Form. Target 35+ responses so you still have 30 after screening. Share it in college and placement groups, LinkedIn, and your Nextleap cohort.

Screener (end the form if the answer disqualifies)

1. Are you currently looking for a job or internship, or did you start your first job in the last 12 months? *(Yes, actively looking / Yes, started in last 12 months / No → end)*
2. How often do you use the ChatGPT mobile app? *(Daily / A few times a week / Weekly / Rarely or never → end)*

Usage

3. For job search, what do you use ChatGPT for? *(Select all: résumé / cover letters / mock interview questions / answering practice / company research / emails to recruiters / LinkedIn posts / other)*
4. Have you ever used voice in the ChatGPT app? *(Mic to dictate / Voice mode conversation / Both / Neither, but I know they exist / Didn't know it existed)*
5. If yes, how often in the last month? *(Never / 1–2 times / Weekly / Several times a week)*

Context (H1)

6. Where are you usually when you use ChatGPT on your phone? *(Select all: own room / shared room or PG / college / office / commute / home with family)*
7. How comfortable would you feel speaking to ChatGPT out loud in those places? *(1 = very uncomfortable … 5 = totally fine)*

Barriers (H2–H6)

8. What stops you from using voice more? *(Select up to 3: people around me / it may not understand my accent or Hinglish / I can't review or edit before it sends / typing is faster for me / I don't know when voice would help / I'm not comfortable with my voice*

being recorded / it gave wrong results before / other)

9. When you type job-search prompts, how often do you edit before sending? *(Never / Sometimes / Usually / Always)*
10. Have you had a bad experience with voice input in any app (Google, Siri, WhatsApp, ChatGPT)? *(Yes, it misheard me / Yes, other issue / No)* — if yes, what happened? *(short text)*

Value (H4)

11. Would you use ChatGPT voice to practise interview answers out loud and get feedback? *(Definitely / Probably / Not sure / Probably not / No)*
12. What would make you try voice in ChatGPT? *(short text)*

Profile (optional): age band, city tier, preferred language (English / Hindi / Hinglish / other), and an email if they're open to a 20-minute interview. That last field is how you recruit for interviews.

Interview guide

Plan 20–30 minutes per call with 5–6 people from the survey's opt-in list. Mix them deliberately: at least 2 who have tried voice and dropped it, 2 who never tried it, 1 from a Tier 2/3 city, and 1 who prefers Hinglish. Record the call (with consent) and note exact quotes.

1. Warm-up (3 min)

- Tell me about your job search right now. What stage are you at?
- Walk me through the last time you used ChatGPT for it. What were you trying to do?

2. Real behaviour (7 min) — ask them to share their screen or open the app

- Show me your last few job-related chats. How did you type that prompt? How long did it take?
- Where were you, and who was around?
- How do you prepare for interviews today? Do you ever practise answers out loud?

3. Voice: experience and mental model (10 min)

- Do you know you can talk to ChatGPT? What do the mic and waveform icons do, in your words? *(note any confusion between the two)*
- Tell me about the last time you used voice anywhere: Google, WhatsApp, Siri, ChatGPT. What happened?
- If you tried ChatGPT voice: what made you stop? If not: what's held you back?
- How do you think it would handle your accent or a Hindi-English mix?

- Is there anything in your job search you wouldn't want to say out loud to an app?

4. Scenario test (5 min)

- "Your interview is tomorrow. ChatGPT offers to ask you 5 questions out loud and give feedback on your spoken answers." Would you do it? Where would you be? What would worry you?
- Have them try Voice mode on one interview question, live. Watch for hesitation, retries, and whether they lower their voice.

5. Wrap-up (2 min)

- If you could change one thing so you'd use voice every week, what would it be?

Probing rules: ask "why?" up to three times; ask for the last real instance, not general opinions; don't pitch voice; record what they *do*, not only what they say.

Analysis plan

Once responses are in, fill these numbers. Each one maps to a marked gap in the Milestone 2 deck.

Deck gap	How to compute it
N (total responses)	Responses that pass both screener questions
% aware of voice but not using it	Q4 = "Neither, but I know they exist" ÷ N
% tried voice, then stopped	Q4 = used, and Q5 = "Never" or "1–2 times"
Top 3 barriers (%)	Count each Q8 option ÷ N; rank them
% in shared spaces	Q6 includes shared room/PG, college, office or commute
Avg comfort speaking out loud	Mean of Q7 (1–5)
% who edit prompts before sending	Q9 = "Usually" or "Always"
% with a bad voice experience	Q10 = "Yes" (either option)
% open to voice mock interviews	Q11 = "Definitely" or "Probably"

Interviews: after each call, write every observation on its own line, tag it H1–H6 (or NEW), then group by tag. Keep 3–4 verbatim quotes that show anxiety or a mental model; those go on slide 2.

Verdicts: mark each hypothesis Confirmed, Partly or Rejected using its kill condition. The deck's problem statement should rest on the confirmed ones only. If the data points elsewhere (say, H4 wins), rewrite the canvas. Don't bend the data to fit the draft.